Future Vision Institute

Future Vision English Course

ADVANCED 2

B2.2 · CEFR

Student Book

Confident English for meetings, interviews, and the news

Stories • News • Podcasts • Conversations



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STORY · LESSON 1

Miss Huda's First Month

Huda got the job. Now she has to get used to early mornings and thirty children. Read the story, then read it from the head teacher's point of view.

- Talk about past habits with used to
- Say what feels normal with be used to
- Describe a change with get used to

1 The story

Huda got the job. Two weeks after her interview with Mrs. Karim, she started work as a teaching assistant at a primary school in Omdurman. On her first morning, her alarm rang at five, and she almost threw her phone across the room. At university, she **used to sleep** until eight. Now she had to be at school before seven.

The first week was hard. Huda **wasn't used to standing** all day, and she **wasn't used to** the noise. When she tried to read the class a story, half of the thirty children talked, and the other half asked to go to the bathroom. By Thursday, she felt like **a fish out of water**. "Maybe I'm not made for this," she told Sara on the phone.

"Of course you are," said Sara. "You **used to be** shy, remember? You **didn't use to speak** in class at all. And now you're a teacher. Give it time."

In the second week, Huda watched Mrs. Karim carefully. She noticed that the head teacher never shouted. Instead, she clapped three times, and the room went quiet. Huda tried it. The first time, nobody listened. The fifth time, half the class clapped back. By the end of the week, everyone did.

Slowly, Huda **got used to** the early mornings. She **got used to** eating her breakfast in two minutes and answering forty questions an hour. She even began to **get the hang of** the old photocopier, which jammed every time someone looked at it.

On the last day of her first month, a small boy called Yassin, who **used to hide** under his desk, stood up and read a whole page aloud. When he finished, the class clapped. Huda had to look out of the window for a moment.

Miss Huda's First Month (continued)

1 The story (continued)

That evening, she called Sara again. "I'm finally **used to** it," she said. "Well, almost." Sara laughed. "See? **Rome wasn't built in a day**."

2 Questions and answers

Answer fast. Short answers are fine.

1 Where did Huda start work?
At a primary school in Omdurman.

2 What time did her alarm ring?
At five.

3 Until what time did she use to sleep at university?
Until eight.

4 What wasn't she used to in the first week?
Standing all day, and the noise.

5 How did she feel by Thursday?
Like a fish out of water.

6 What did Sara remind her?
That she used to be shy and didn't use to speak in class.

7 What did Mrs. Karim do instead of shouting?
She clapped three times.

8 What happened the fifth time Huda clapped?
Half the class clapped back.

9 What did Huda slowly get used to?
The early mornings, eating breakfast in two minutes, and answering forty questions an hour.

10 What was wrong with the photocopier?
It jammed every time someone looked at it.

11 What did Yassin use to do?
Hide under his desk.

12 What did Yassin do on the last day of the month?
He stood up and read a whole page aloud.

Miss Huda's First Month (continued)

3 Point of view

Now Mrs. Karim tells it.

MK

When Huda started at our school, I could see that she **wasn't used to** young children. Her voice was too quiet, and she **was used to** students who listened. In her first week, the class didn't hear a word she said.

But she watched and learned. She noticed that I never shout, and she started to clap like me. Teachers **used to shout** a lot when I was young, but I have never believed in it.

By the end of the month, she **had gotten used to** everything, the noise, the early mornings, and even our terrible photocopier.

I knew she would be a good teacher on the day Yassin read aloud. That boy **used to hide** under his desk, and Huda had sat with him every day for a month. I think they are both a little braver now.

4 What did you learn?

You learned used to, be used to, and get used to.

They look similar, but they mean different things. Used to is about the past. Be used to and get used to are about what feels normal.

FORM	MEANING	EXAMPLE
used to + verb	a habit in the past, not now	She **used to sleep** until eight.
didn't use to + verb	not a habit in the past	She **didn't use to speak** in class.
be used to + noun / -ing	it feels normal now	She **is used to** the noise now.
get used to + noun / -ing	it is becoming normal	She **got used to** getting up early.

Miss Huda's First Month (continued)

4 What did you learn? (continued)

used to has no present
For now, say: I usually get up at five. Not: I use to get up.

After be / get used to: -ing
I'm used to getting up early. Not: I'm used to get up.

Say it: yoost-tuh
In used to, the s sounds like s, not z.

QUESTIONS **What did you use to do as a child that you don't do now?**

I used to play football every afternoon.

5 Idioms, proverbs and phrases

IDIOM

feel like a fish out of water

to feel uncomfortable because a place or situation is new to you

Example: *On my first day at the new school, I felt like a fish out of water.*

PHRASE

get the hang of something

to learn how to do something, usually after some practice

Example: *Driving was difficult at first, but I soon got the hang of it.*

PROVERB

Rome wasn't built in a day.

Important things take time, so be patient.

Example: *You won't speak perfect English in a month. Rome wasn't built in a day.*

6 New words

shy	nervous and quiet with other people	**clapped**	hit your hands together to make a noise
photocopier	a machine that makes copies of papers	**jammed**	got stuck and stopped working
aloud	in a voice that other people can hear	**braver**	less afraid than before

TOPIC · LESSON 2

Life Before Smartphones

How people called, found their way, and kept in touch before the phone in your pocket, and what we have got used to.

Compare life then and now | Use used to and be used to | Talk about technology in your life

1 Read

Today, most of us check our phones more than fifty times a day, and it is hard to imagine life without them. But only twenty years ago, things were very different. How did people live before **smartphones**?

First, people used to remember things. Most people knew dozens of phone numbers by heart. To call someone, they used a **landline**, a phone connected to the wall. If nobody was home, they simply tried again later.

To find their way in a new city, people used paper **maps**, or they stopped and asked for directions. Getting lost was normal, and sometimes it led to an adventure.

To **keep in touch** with family in another country, people wrote **letters**, and a letter could take two or three weeks to arrive. A phone call abroad was so expensive that many families made one only **once in a blue moon**, on Eid or for very important news.

Photos were different too. A **film** camera could take only thirty-six pictures, and you didn't see them until they were printed in a shop. So people took photos of special moments only.

Today, we are used to answers in seconds, maps that speak, and video calls that cost nothing. Most of this is wonderful. But some experts say that we should sometimes put our phones away, because the people who lived before smartphones were better at one thing. They knew how to be bored.

2 Then and now

Numbers
then remembered · now saved

Directions
then paper maps · now GPS

Family abroad
then letters · now video calls

Photos
then 36 on a film · now thousands

Life Before Smartphones (continued)

3 Questions and answers

Answer fast. Short answers are fine.

1 How many times a day do most of us check our phones?
More than fifty.

2 What is a landline?
A phone connected to the wall.

3 How did people find their way in a new city?
With paper maps, or by asking for directions.

4 How long could a letter take to arrive?
Two or three weeks.

5 Why did families call abroad only once in a blue moon?
Because calls were very expensive.

6 How many pictures could a film camera take?
Thirty-six.

7 What were people before smartphones better at?
Being bored.

4 Idioms, proverbs and phrases

PHRASE

keep in touch

to stay in contact with someone by writing or calling

Example: *After she moved to Cairo, we kept in touch by phone.*

IDIOM

once in a blue moon

very rarely

Example: *My uncle lives far away, so we see him only once in a blue moon.*

5 New words

dozens	many, in groups of twelve	**by heart**	from memory
directions	information about how to get to a place	**abroad**	in or to another country
printed	put onto paper by a machine	**bored**	tired because nothing interesting is happening

CONVERSATION · LESSON 3

Looking for an Apartment

Calling about an apartment to rent

Ask about an apartment | Talk about what you are used to | Ask to visit before you decide

1 Read the conversation

Adam wants to live closer to the flying school. He calls Mr. Hassan, who has an apartment to rent.

MH	MR. HASSAN	Hello, Hassan speaking.
A	ADAM	Hello. I'm calling about the apartment near the flying school. Is it still available?
MH	MR. HASSAN	Yes. It's a one-bedroom apartment on the second floor, with a small kitchen and a balcony. It's very quiet, too.
A	ADAM	That sounds good. I'm not used to living alone, so I'd like somewhere near shops. Is there a market nearby?
MH	MR. HASSAN	There's one five minutes away. The rent is paid monthly, but I ask for two months in advance.
A	ADAM	Two months in advance? Apartments near the school really cost an arm and a leg.
MH	MR. HASSAN	I understand. But water is included, and the furniture is new. You won't need to buy anything.
A	ADAM	That helps. Can I come and see it before I decide?
MH	MR. HASSAN	Of course. Come tomorrow at five. Then you can sleep on it and call me the next day.
A	ADAM	Perfect. Thank you, Mr. Hassan. See you tomorrow.

2 Useful phrases

ASK IF IT IS FREE
Is it still available?

SAY WHAT YOU ARE USED TO
I'm not used to living alone.

ASK ABOUT THE AREA
Is there a market nearby?

REACT TO THE PRICE
Two months in advance?

ASK TO VISIT
Can I come and see it before I decide?

END THE CALL
Thank you. See you tomorrow.

Looking for an Apartment (continued)

3 Idioms, proverbs and phrases

IDIOM

cost an arm and a leg

to be very expensive

Example: *I love that car, but it costs an arm and a leg.*

PHRASE

sleep on it

to wait until the next day before you make a decision

Example: *It's a big decision. Let me sleep on it, and I'll call you tomorrow.*

4 New words

available	free for someone to take or use	**nearby**	not far away
monthly	once a month	**in advance**	before the time you need it
included	part of the price	**furniture**	beds, chairs, tables, and other things in a home

STORY · LESSON 4

The Road Not Taken

Thirty years ago, Mr. Ali said no to a job that would have made him rich. Read the story, then read it from the point of view of a girl in his class.

Imagine a different present | Use mixed conditionals | Talk about big decisions

1 The story

Thirty years ago, Mr. Ali was in his first year as a teacher at a small school in Khartoum, and he loved it. Then one day, a letter arrived from a bank in Dubai. They were offering him a job as a translator, with a salary ten times bigger than his. He was **at a crossroads**.

His friends told him to go. His father told him to go. Even the head teacher said, "Ali, an offer like this won't come again."

The Road Not Taken (continued)

1 The story (continued)

But that week, a quiet girl in his class, who had never answered a question, put up her hand. "Teacher, what does future mean?" she asked. Mr. Ali explained, and he saw her face change. That night, he wrote to the bank and **turned down** the job.

Last week, his students asked him about it. "Do you ever wish you had gone?" asked Omar. Mr. Ali smiled. "Sometimes. **If I had taken** that job, I **would be** rich now. I **would be living** in a big apartment by the sea, and I **would have** a much nicer car."

"So why didn't you go?" asked Adam. "**If I had gone** to Dubai," said Mr. Ali, "I **wouldn't know** any of you. Huda **wouldn't be** a teacher, because nobody would have pushed her to apply. And that quiet girl? You know her. Her name is Dr. Amira Salih. She was a guest on your podcast."

The room went silent. Then Sara asked, "But don't you ever wonder?" "Of course," said Mr. Ali. "**The grass is always greener on the other side**. But when I look at my side, I see thirty years of students. **If I were** rich, I **wouldn't be** this happy."

2 Questions and answers

Answer fast. Short answers are fine.

1 **What was Mr. Ali doing thirty years ago?**
He was in his first year as a teacher.

2 **Where did the letter come from?**
From a bank in Dubai.

3 **What job were they offering him?**
A job as a translator.

4 **How big was the salary?**
Ten times bigger than his.

5 **What did his friends and his father tell him?**
To go.

6 **What did the quiet girl ask?**
What future means.

7 **What did Mr. Ali do that night?**
He wrote to the bank and turned down the job.

8 **What would he be now if he had taken the job?**
Rich.

The Road Not Taken (continued)

2 Questions and answers (continued)

9 Where would he be living?
In a big apartment by the sea.

10 Why wouldn't Huda be a teacher?
Because nobody would have pushed her to apply.

11 Who was the quiet girl?
Dr. Amira Salih.

12 What does Mr. Ali see when he looks at his side?
Thirty years of students.

3 Point of view Now Dr. Amira tells it.

DA

When I was nine, I was the quietest girl in the class. I never answered a question, because I was afraid of being wrong.

Then one day, a young teacher wrote the word future on the board. I didn't know what it meant, and for the first time, I put up my hand. He explained it so kindly that I went home and told my mother I wanted to study the future. Today, that's my job.

Years later, I learned that he had a job offer in Dubai that same week, and he said no. **If he had left**, I **might not be** a scientist today. I **might** still **be** afraid of my own questions.

Last month, I visited his class to say thank you. He pretended that he didn't remember me. But he did.

4 What did you learn?

You learned mixed conditionals.

We use them when a different past would change the present. The if part is about the past, and the result is about now.

A DIFFERENT PAST	A DIFFERENT NOW
If I had taken that job,	I **would be** rich now.
If I had gone to Dubai,	I **wouldn't know** any of you.
If he had left,	I **might not be** a scientist today.
If I hadn't studied English,	I **wouldn't be** a teacher.

The Road Not Taken (continued)

4 What did you learn? (continued)

If + had done, would + do
If I had studied medicine, I would be a doctor now.

The other way: now and past
If I were braver, I would have taken the job.

might or could for maybe
She might not be a scientist today.

QUESTIONS **How would your life be different if you had grown up in another country?**

If I had grown up in Japan, I would speak Japanese.

5 Idioms, proverbs and phrases

IDIOM

be at a crossroads

to be at a time when you must make an important decision

Example: *After school, I was at a crossroads. Should I work or go to university?*

PHRASE

turn down

to say no to an offer

Example: *She turned down the job because it was too far from home.*

PROVERB

The grass is always greener on the other side.

Other people's lives always seem better than ours, even when they are not.

Example: *My friend wants my job, and I want his. The grass is always greener on the other side.*

6 New words

translator	a person who changes words from one language into another	**salary**	the money you get every month for your job
apply	ask for a job or a place at a school in writing	**silent**	with no sound at all
wonder	think about something and want to know more	**pretended**	acted as if something was true when it was not

SCIENCE · LESSON 5

The Green Sahara

Thousands of years ago, the biggest hot desert in the world was full of lakes, rivers, and animals. What changed?

- Explain how a place changed over time
- Talk about evidence from the past
- Use if with a different past and a different present

1 Read

Today, the **Sahara** is the largest hot desert in the world. It covers most of North Africa, including much of northern Sudan. But about 10,000 years ago, it looked completely different. It was green.

Scientists call this time the African Humid Period. For thousands of years, heavy summer rains reached far into the desert. There were grasslands, trees, and huge lakes, and hippos, giraffes, and elephants lived where there is only sand today.

How do we know? The people who lived there left **rock art**, paintings and carvings on the rocks that show cattle, giraffes, and even people swimming. In Sudan, scientists have found that **Wadi Howar**, a dry valley in the northwest, was once a long river that carried water toward the Nile. Some call it the Yellow Nile. But the rock art and the old riverbeds are only **the tip of the iceberg**. Under the sand, there are old villages, tools, and fish bones.

So what changed? The answer is in space. The Earth slowly **wobbles** as it turns, like a spinning top. Over thousands of years, this changed how much summer sunlight reached North Africa. With less sunlight, the summer rains moved south, the lakes and rivers **dried up**, and about 5,000 years ago, the desert returned.

Many people moved toward the Nile, where there was still water. Some historians believe that if the Sahara had stayed green, life in the Nile Valley would be very different today. And the Earth is still wobbling, so in thousands of years, the Sahara may be green again.

2 How the green Sahara became a desert

1. **Wobble** — the Earth slowly tilts in a new way
2. **Less sun** — summers in North Africa get weaker
3. **Less rain** — the summer rains move south
4. **Desert** — lakes and rivers dry up

The Green Sahara (continued)

DID YOU KNOW? The Sahara is almost as big as the United States, but only about a quarter of it is sand. The rest is rock, stones, and mountains.

3 Questions and answers

Answer fast. Short answers are fine.

1 **How long ago was the Sahara green?**
About 10,000 years ago.

2 **Which animals lived there?**
Hippos, giraffes, and elephants.

3 **What does the rock art show?**
Cattle, giraffes, and even people swimming.

4 **What was Wadi Howar?**
A long river that carried water toward the Nile.

5 **Why did the summer rains move south?**
The Earth's wobble changed how much summer sunlight reached North Africa.

6 **When did the desert return?**
About 5,000 years ago.

7 **Where did many people move?**
Toward the Nile, where there was still water.

4 Idioms, proverbs and phrases

IDIOM

the tip of the iceberg

a small part of something much bigger that you can't see yet

Example: *The money he lost is only the tip of the iceberg. His whole business is in trouble.*

PHRASE

dry up

to lose all its water

Example: *In the hot summer, the small river near our village dries up.*

5 New words

covers	is spread over a place	**humid**	with a lot of water in the air
carvings	pictures cut into stone or wood	**cattle**	cows that people keep for milk and meat
valley	low land between hills or mountains	**historians**	people who study the past

CONVERSATION · LESSON 6

My Flight Has Been Canceled

Finding a solution at the airline desk

Explain a travel problem | Talk about a different past and present | Ask for better options

1 Read the conversation

Sara is at Khartoum airport. Her flight to Cairo has been canceled, and she is speaking at a conference there this afternoon. She goes to the airline desk.

AGENT	Good morning. How can I help you?
SARA	Good morning. My flight to Cairo at ten has been canceled, and I'm speaking at a conference there this afternoon.
AGENT	I'm very sorry. There's a problem with the plane. Everyone on that flight is in the same boat, I'm afraid.
SARA	If I had booked the earlier flight, I would be in Cairo now. What are my options?
AGENT	There's a flight at four this afternoon, or one tomorrow at seven in the morning.
SARA	My talk is at five, so four is too late. Is there anything earlier, on another airline?
AGENT	Let me check. Yes, there's one seat on a flight at one. We'll pay for the change, and you'll get a meal voucher.
SARA	That's wonderful. I'll arrive just in time.
AGENT	Look on the bright side. If you hadn't come to the desk so early, that seat would be gone now.
SARA	That's true. Thank you so much for your help.

2 Useful phrases

EXPLAIN THE PROBLEM
My flight has been canceled.

SAY WHY IT MATTERS
I'm speaking at a conference this afternoon.

IMAGINE A DIFFERENT PAST
If I had booked the earlier flight, I would be in Cairo now.

ASK FOR OPTIONS
What are my options?

ASK FOR SOMETHING BETTER
Is there anything earlier, on another airline?

THANK SOMEONE
Thank you so much for your help.

My Flight Has Been Canceled (continued)

3 Idioms, proverbs and phrases

IDIOM

be in the same boat

to be in the same difficult situation as other people

Example: *Don't worry about the exam. We're all in the same boat.*

PHRASE

look on the bright side

to see the good part of a bad situation

Example: *You missed the bus, but look on the bright side. You got some exercise!*

4 New words

canceled	stopped so that it will not happen	**booked**	paid for a seat or a room before you use it
options	things you can choose from	**airline**	a company that flies planes for passengers
voucher	a paper you can use instead of money	**just in time**	at the last moment, but not late

STORY · LESSON 7

Omar's New Office

Omar wants a professional office in one week. He has the walls painted, a sign made, and the internet installed, and everything goes wrong. Read the story, then read it from Sara's point of view.

Say what other people do for you | Use have and get something done | Tell a funny story about a bad week

1 The story

After a year at Dr. Idris's company, Omar finally started his own business, a small company that repairs phones and builds apps. He rented a room above a shop in the market and decided to make it look professional. "It'll be a piece of cake," he told Adam. "I'll have everything done in a week."

Omar's New Office (continued)

1 The story (continued)

On Monday, he **had** the walls **painted** blue. When he came back in the evening, they were bright green. "Blue was finished," the painter explained. "Green is nicer."

On Tuesday, he **got** a sign **made** for the door. It said OMAR'S TECNOLOGY. "Where's the H?" Omar asked. "Letters are expensive," said the sign maker. "Nobody will notice."

On Wednesday, he **had** the internet **installed**. The man worked for three hours, drank four cups of tea, and left. The internet worked for exactly twenty minutes.

By Thursday, Omar was tired of waiting for other people. "**If you want something done right, do it yourself**," he said, and he bought a can of blue paint. Two hours later, the walls were blue and green, and so were Omar, the floor, and the window.

That evening, Sara came to see the office. She looked at the walls, the sign, and Omar's blue hair, and she tried not to laugh. "Maybe you just need the right people," she said. The next day, she called her cousin, a painter who never changed colors. Huda's brother **got** the sign **fixed** in an hour, and Adam's uncle **had** the internet **checked** by a friend who really knew what he was doing.

A week later, the office looked perfect. Omar **sorted out** the last problem himself, a door that wouldn't close, and he opened the business on Sunday. His first customer was Mr. Ali, who wanted to **have** his phone **repaired**. "Don't worry," Omar said. "I'll do this one myself."

2 Questions and answers

Answer fast. Short answers are fine.

1 **What does Omar's company do?**
It repairs phones and builds apps.

2 **Where did he rent a room?**
Above a shop in the market.

3 **What did Omar tell Adam?**
That it would be a piece of cake, and he would have everything done in a week.

4 **What color did Omar want the walls?**
Blue.

Omar's New Office (continued)

2 Questions and answers (continued)

5 What color were they when he came back?
Bright green.

6 What was wrong with the sign?
The H was missing. It said TECNOLOGY.

7 How long did the internet work?
For exactly twenty minutes.

8 What happened when Omar painted the walls himself?
The walls were blue and green, and so were Omar, the floor, and the window.

9 What did Sara say?
Maybe he just needed the right people.

10 Who got the sign fixed?
Huda's brother.

11 What problem did Omar sort out himself?
A door that wouldn't close.

12 Who was his first customer?
Mr. Ali.

3 Point of view Now Sara tells it.

S

Omar called me on Thursday night. "Come and see my office," he said. He sounded very tired.

When I arrived, the walls were blue and green, the sign on the door said TECNOLOGY, and Omar had blue paint in his hair. He told me that he **had had** the walls **painted**, **got** a sign **made**, and **had** the internet **installed**, and that everything had gone wrong.

So I made three phone calls. By Saturday, we **had** everything **fixed** by people who knew what they were doing.

Omar says that he learned a lesson about business that week. I think he learned a lesson about paint.

Omar's New Office (continued)

4 What did you learn?

You learned the causative, have or get something done.

We use it when another person does a job for us. We say what was done, not who did it.

HAVE / GET + THING + PAST PARTICIPLE	WHAT IT MEANS
He had the walls painted.	A painter painted them for him.
He got a sign made.	Someone made it for him.
He had the internet installed.	A technician installed it.
I want to have my phone repaired.	I want someone to repair it.

get is less formal
I got my hair cut. I had my hair cut.

Who did it? Add by
We had everything fixed by people who knew the job.

Bad things too
He had his phone stolen. He didn't want that!

QUESTIONS **What do you have done instead of doing it yourself?**

I have my hair cut every month.

5 Idioms, proverbs and phrases

IDIOM

a piece of cake

something that is very easy to do

Example: *The test was a piece of cake. I finished in ten minutes.*

PROVERB

If you want something done right, do it yourself.

Other people may not do a job as well as you want, so sometimes it is better to do it yourself.

Example: *My brother never cleans the car properly. If you want something done right, do it yourself.*

PHRASE

sort out

to solve a problem or put something right

Example: *There's a problem with my bank card, but I'll sort it out tomorrow.*

Omar's New Office (continued)

6 New words

business	a company that sells things or services	**rented**	paid money to use a place for some time
professional	done well, like the work of an expert	**painter**	a person whose job is to paint walls and buildings
notice	see something and pay attention to it	**exactly**	no more and no less

PODCAST · LESSON 8

Starting Your Own Business

Sara and Adam talk to a guest they know very well, Omar, about his first six months as a business owner.

Follow a podcast interview · Talk about starting a business · Use have and get something done

1 Before you listen

? Would you like to start your own business one day? What kind?

? What do you think is the hardest part of starting a business?

2 Listen and read

The Future Vision Podcast · Episode 18

Hosts: Sara and Adam · Guest: Omar, who started a phone repair and app company

00:05	ADAM	Welcome back to The Future Vision Podcast. I'm Adam.
00:08	SARA	And I'm Sara. Today's guest is someone we know very well. He started his own company six months ago. Welcome, Omar!
00:16	OMAR	Thanks. It's strange to be on this side of the microphone.
00:20	ADAM	So, Omar, why did you decide to be your own boss?
00:24	OMAR	I worked for a big company for a year, and I loved it. That's where I learned the ropes. But I always wanted to build something of my own.
00:35	SARA	What was the hardest part at the beginning?

Starting Your Own Business (continued)

2 Listen and read (continued)

00:38	OMAR	Doing everything! At first, I tried to do it all myself. Now I **have** my accounts **done** by an accountant, and I **had** our logo **designed** by a student at the art college.
00:52	ADAM	Why didn't you design it yourself?
00:54	OMAR	Have you seen my office walls? I learned that it's cheaper to **get** things **done** by experts than to do them badly.
01:05	SARA	How did you find your first customers?
01:08	OMAR	Mostly through friends and family. One happy customer tells five others. I also **had** a simple website **made**, so people can book repairs online.
01:22	ADAM	What advice would you give a student who wants to start a business?
01:26	OMAR	Start small, and keep your costs low. Don't rent a big office on the first day. And find people you trust, because you can't do everything alone.
01:40	SARA	And what's next for the company?
01:43	OMAR	We're building an app that helps farmers **get** their phones **repaired** without traveling to the city. We're testing it next month.
01:55	ADAM	That's exciting. Omar, thank you for coming.
01:58	OMAR	Thank you for having me.
02:01	SARA	That's all for this week. Next week, we're talking about sleep, and why students never get enough. See you then!

3 Questions and answers

Answer fast. Short answers are fine.

1 **When did Omar start his company?**
Six months ago.

2 **Where did he learn the ropes?**
At a big company, where he worked for a year.

3 **Who does his accounts now?**
An accountant.

4 **Who designed the logo?**
A student at the art college.

Starting Your Own Business (continued)

3 Questions and answers (continued)

5 What did Omar learn about getting things done?
It's cheaper to get things done by experts than to do them badly.

6 How did he find his first customers?
Mostly through friends and family.

7 What advice does he give students?
Start small, keep your costs low, and find people you trust.

8 What is the company building?
An app that helps farmers get their phones repaired without traveling to the city.

4 Idioms, proverbs and phrases

PHRASE

be your own boss

to work for yourself and not for a company

Example: *My uncle left his job to be his own boss. Now he has a small shop.*

IDIOM

learn the ropes

to learn the basic things you need to know to do a job

Example: *In my first month at the bank, I was still learning the ropes.*

5 New words

microphone	a machine that you speak into to record your voice	**accounts**	the records of the money a business gets and spends
accountant	a person whose job is to keep accounts	**logo**	the small picture that a company uses as its sign
experts	people who know a lot about something	**costs**	the money you have to spend

STORY · LESSON 9

Who Ate the Cake?

A birthday cake disappears from the institute, and everyone is a suspect. Read the story, then read it from Mr. Ali's point of view.

- Report what people said with reporting verbs
- Use the right pattern after each verb
- Tell a funny mystery

1 The story

It was almost Mr. Ali's sixtieth birthday, and his students had planned a surprise. On Wednesday afternoon, Huda bought a big chocolate cake from the best bakery in town and hid it in the fridge in the teachers' room. The party was going to be on Thursday morning, before the first class, and everyone **promised to keep** it a secret.

On Thursday, Huda opened the fridge. The cake was gone. "Somebody has taken it!" she cried. Within minutes, the whole class was in the teachers' room, and everyone was looking at everyone else.

Omar looked at Adam. "You were here late last night," he said. Adam **denied going** anywhere near the fridge. "I was only printing the birthday card," he said. Then Sara **accused Omar of eating** it, because there was chocolate on his shirt. "You've been caught red-handed!" she said. Omar **admitted eating** chocolate, but only a chocolate bar from the shop. "I **refuse to be** blamed for a crime I didn't commit," he said dramatically.

Huda was close to tears. Sara, practical as always, **suggested checking** the security camera in the corridor. The guard **agreed to show** them the video, but he **warned them not to expect** much. "That camera is older than I am," he said.

They watched in silence. At 9:40 the night before, a figure walked into the teachers' room and came out carrying a large white box. The picture wasn't clear, but the walk was. Everyone knew that slow, careful walk. The thief turned out to be Mr. Ali himself.

Who Ate the Cake? (continued)

1 The story (continued)

At that moment, the door opened, and Mr. Ali came in, carrying the box. "Good morning," he said. "I found this in the fridge last night. There was no name on it, and the cleaners empty the fridge on Thursdays, so I took it home to keep it safe." Then he opened the box and read the words on top: Happy Birthday, Mr. Ali. He laughed so much that he had to sit down.

He **apologized for spoiling** the surprise, and the students **insisted on having** the party anyway. "Well," said Mr. Ali, "**don't judge a book by its cover**. I looked like a thief, and so did Omar." As for Omar, everyone agreed that he still owed them a chocolate bar.

2 Questions and answers

Answer fast. Short answers are fine.

1 **Whose birthday was it?**
Mr. Ali's. It was almost his sixtieth.

2 **Where did Huda hide the cake?**
In the fridge in the teachers' room.

3 **When was the party going to be?**
On Thursday morning, before the first class.

4 **What had everyone promised?**
To keep it a secret.

5 **What did Adam deny?**
Going anywhere near the fridge.

6 **Why did Sara accuse Omar?**
Because there was chocolate on his shirt.

7 **What did Omar admit?**
Eating a chocolate bar from the shop.

8 **What did Sara suggest?**
Checking the security camera in the corridor.

9 **What did the guard warn them?**
Not to expect much, because the camera was old.

10 **What did the video show?**
A figure carrying a large white box out of the teachers' room.

11 **Why did Mr. Ali take the box home?**
There was no name on it, and the cleaners empty the fridge on Thursdays.

12 **What did the students insist on?**
Having the party anyway.

Who Ate the Cake? (continued)

3 Point of view

Now Mr. Ali tells it.

MA

On Wednesday night, I stayed late to mark exams. Before I left, I opened the fridge and found a big white box with no name on it. The cleaners empty the fridge on Thursdays, so I decided to take it home and keep it safe. I didn't even look inside.

The next morning, I walked into the teachers' room with the box and found my whole class there. They looked at me as if I were a criminal, and poor Huda looked as if she had been crying.

Then I opened the box and read the words on the cake. I laughed until I had to sit down. I **apologized for spoiling** their surprise, and I **promised to look** inside every box before I take it home.

Later, Sara told me the whole story. Adam had **denied going** near the fridge, and Omar had been **accused of eating** the cake. Omar still **insists on telling** everyone that he is innocent. I believe him. Mostly.

4 What did you learn?

You learned reporting verbs.

When we report what people said, we often choose a verb that shows what they meant, a promise, a warning, or an apology. Each verb has its own pattern.

PATTERN	EXAMPLE
to do · promise, agree, refuse, offer	Everyone **promised to keep** it a secret.
someone **(not) to do** · warn, advise, ask, tell	He **warned them not to expect** much.
-ing · deny, admit, suggest	Adam **denied going** near the fridge.
someone **of / for -ing** · accuse, blame	Sara **accused Omar of eating** it.
for / on -ing · apologize for, insist on	He **apologized for spoiling** the surprise.

Who Ate the Cake? (continued)

4 What did you learn? (continued)

suggest + -ing
Sara suggested checking the camera. Not: suggested to check.

Negative: not before to or -ing
He warned them not to expect much. He admitted not knowing.

They say more than said
"It wasn't me!" He denied doing it. "I'll help." He offered to help.

QUESTIONS **What have you promised to do this week?**

I've promised to help my brother with his homework.

5 Idioms, proverbs and phrases

IDIOM
be caught red-handed
to be found while you are doing something wrong
Example: *The boy was caught red-handed with his hand in the cookie jar.*

PHRASE
turn out
to be found to be true in the end, often as a surprise
Example: *The exam turned out to be easier than we expected.*

PROVERB
Don't judge a book by its cover.
Don't decide what someone or something is like only from the way they look.
Example: *The restaurant looked old, but the food was wonderful. Don't judge a book by its cover.*

6 New words

bakery a shop that makes and sells bread and cakes

dramatically in a way that is meant to impress people, like an actor

figure the shape of a person you can't see clearly

blamed said to be the person who did something wrong

corridor a long, narrow passage inside a building

owed had to give something back to someone

NEWS · LESSON 10

Police Warn of Phone Scam

Read a news report about a crime, and notice how reporters use verbs like warn, admit, and deny.

- Read a crime report
- Find who, what, where, when, and why
- Notice reporting verbs in the news

1 Read the article

THE DAILY NILE Monday, March 9

Police Warn Public About Text Message Scam

Criminals are sending messages that look as if they come from banks, and dozens of people have already lost money.

BY OUR CRIME REPORTER

Police in Khartoum have **warned** the public **not to share** bank codes with anyone, after dozens of people lost money to a new text message scam this month.

The messages look as if they come from a real bank. They tell people that they have won a prize, or that their account will be closed, and they ask them to send a secret code. "It sounded too good to be true, and it was," said one victim, a teacher who lost two months' salary. She **admitted sending** the code without thinking.

> ***"It sounded too good to be true, and it was."***
>
> A TEACHER WHO LOST TWO MONTHS' SALARY

A police spokesperson **explained that** the criminals often call after sending the message, pretending to be bank staff. "They are polite, they know your name, and they sound very professional," she said. "That's why so many people fall for it."

Banks have **promised to return** money to some of the victims, but they have **advised** customers **to check** every message carefully. "We will never ask you for a code by phone or text," said a manager at one bank.

One man was arrested last week, but he **denied being** part of the group. Police have **asked** anyone who receives a strange message **to report** it, and they have **suggested calling** the bank directly, using the number on the back of the card.

Police Warn of Phone Scam (continued)

2 The five key facts

Who?	What?	Where?	When?	Why?
criminals pretending to be bank staff	a text message scam	Khartoum	this month	to steal money with secret bank codes

3 Questions and answers

Answer fast. Short answers are fine.

1 **What have police warned the public not to do?**
Share bank codes with anyone.

2 **What do the messages tell people?**
That they have won a prize, or that their account will be closed.

3 **What did the teacher admit?**
Sending the code without thinking.

4 **How do the criminals sound on the phone?**
Polite and very professional.

5 **What have the banks promised?**
To return money to some of the victims.

6 **What did the arrested man deny?**
Being part of the group.

7 **What have police suggested?**
Calling the bank directly, using the number on the back of the card.

4 Idioms, proverbs and phrases

IDIOM

too good to be true

so good that it is probably not real

Example: *A new phone for only ten pounds? It's too good to be true.*

PHRASE

fall for something

to believe a trick or a lie

Example: *He told me the shop was giving away free cars, but I didn't fall for it.*

5 New words

scam	a clever trick to steal money	**prize**	something you get when you win
victim	a person who is hurt or cheated by a crime	**spokesperson**	a person who speaks to the public for a group
criminals	people who break the law	**arrested**	taken away by the police

CONVERSATION · LESSON 11

The Team Meeting

Making suggestions, disagreeing politely, and agreeing on a plan

Make and answer suggestions | Disagree politely | Sum up what people said

1 Read the conversation

Sara leads a meeting with two engineers from her team, Tarig and Mona. Two more villages have asked for solar pumps.

SARA	OK, everyone. The pump near Kassala is working well, and two more villages have asked for one. We need a plan. Any ideas?
TARIG	I suggest starting with the bigger village. More people need the water there.
MONA	I see your point, but the road to that village is closed in the rainy season. If we start there, we could lose two months.
TARIG	That's true. I hadn't thought of that.
SARA	What if we start with the smaller village now and do the bigger one after the rains?
MONA	That makes sense. But we'll need more solar panels, and the budget is tight.
TARIG	Could we ask the university for help? They promised to support projects like ours.
SARA	Good idea. Mona, could you come up with a list of everything we need by Thursday?
MONA	Sure. I'll send it to everyone on Thursday morning.
SARA	Great. So, Tarig suggested asking the university, Mona agreed to make the list, and we'll start with the small village. Are we all on the same page?

2 Useful phrases

OPEN THE MEETING
We need a plan. Any ideas?

MAKE A SUGGESTION
I suggest starting with the bigger village.
What if we start with the smaller village?

DISAGREE POLITELY
I see your point, but…

AGREE
That's true.
That makes sense.

GIVE SOMEONE A TASK
Could you come up with a list by Thursday?

SUM UP
So, Tarig suggested asking the university, and Mona agreed to make the list.

The Team Meeting (continued)

3 Idioms, proverbs and phrases

PHRASE

come up with

to think of an idea, a plan, or an answer

Example: *We need to come up with a name for our new shop.*

IDIOM

be on the same page

to agree about a plan and understand it in the same way

Example: *Before we start, let's make sure we're all on the same page.*

4 New words

rainy season	the months of the year when it rains a lot	**makes sense**	is a good idea that is easy to understand
budget	the money you can spend on something	**tight**	with only a little money, not enough for everything
support	help someone or something	**projects**	pieces of planned work

STORY · LESSON 12

Adam Flies Alone

Six months after his first lesson, Adam is told that today he will fly with nobody next to him. Read the story, then read it from his instructor's point of view.

Give emphasis to what matters most · Use what clauses and it was … that · Describe an important moment

1 The story

Six months after his first lesson, Adam arrived at the flying school on a calm Tuesday morning. Captain Nour was waiting by the plane, as usual. But this time, she didn't climb in. "Today," she said, "you're going up alone."

Adam had imagined this moment a thousand times, but now that it had come, he had butterflies in his stomach. "Are you sure?" he asked. Captain Nour smiled. "What you need now is confidence, not more lessons. It's your hands that know how to fly, not mine."

Adam Flies Alone (continued)

1 The story (continued)

He did his checks slowly and carefully, twice. Then he called the tower, and the voice on the radio said, "Cleared for take-off." The plane rolled down the runway, faster and faster, and then the ground fell away.

The first thing he noticed was the silence. There was nobody next to him, and no calm voice saying, "Gently." For a moment, his hands shook. Then he remembered the years of saving, the long nights reading about planes, and his grandfather's favorite words. "**Where there's a will, there's a way**." He took a deep breath and **pulled himself together**.

He flew one circle around the airfield. The Nile was shining below, just like on his first day, but this time, the sky was all his. When he landed, Captain Nour was clapping. Behind her, holding a sign that said WELL DONE, CAPTAIN ADAM, were Sara, Omar, and Huda. This time, Omar had checked every letter.

That evening, at the café, Sara asked him how it felt. Adam thought for a moment. "**What I remember most is** the silence," he said. "**It was** at that moment **that** I understood I was really a pilot."

"And how did you know we would be there?" asked Huda. "I didn't," said Adam. "But I think I know who told you. **It was** my grandfather, **wasn't it?**" Sara smiled. "Captain Nour told him yesterday, and he couldn't keep the secret for an hour."

2 Questions and answers

Answer fast. Short answers are fine.

1 **When did Adam fly alone?**
Six months after his first lesson.

2 **What did Captain Nour say?**
Today, you're going up alone.

3 **How did Adam feel?**
He had butterflies in his stomach.

4 **What did Captain Nour say he needed now?**
Confidence, not more lessons.

5 **How many times did he do his checks?**
Twice.

6 **What did the voice on the radio say?**
Cleared for take-off.

Adam Flies Alone (continued)

2 Questions and answers (continued)

7 What was the first thing he noticed?
The silence.

8 What were his grandfather's favorite words?
Where there's a will, there's a way.

9 What did the sign say?
WELL DONE, CAPTAIN ADAM.

10 What does Adam remember most?
The silence.

11 When did he understand that he was really a pilot?
At that moment, in the silence.

12 Who told the friends to come?
Adam's grandfather.

3 Point of view Now Captain Nour tells it.

CN

What I love most about my job is the day a student flies alone. I have seen it many times, and it still makes me nervous.

Adam was ready weeks ago, but he didn't know it. **It was** his confidence **that** needed more time, not his flying. So last Tuesday, I simply told him that he was going alone.

From the ground, I watched every second. His take-off was good, and his landing was even better. **What surprised me was** how calm he looked when he climbed out.

Of course, I had told his grandfather the day before. **It was** the only secret I have ever shared with a student's family, and I don't regret it.

4 What did you learn?

You learned cleft sentences.

We use them to give emphasis, to point at the most important part of what we say.

NORMAL SENTENCE	WITH EMPHASIS
I remember the silence most.	**What I remember most is** the silence.
You need confidence now.	**What you need now is** confidence.
I understood it at that moment.	**It was at that moment that** I understood.
My grandfather told you.	**It was** my grandfather **who** told you.

Adam Flies Alone (continued)

4 What did you learn? (continued)

What … is / was …
What I need is a holiday.
What surprised me was his calm.

It is / It was … that / who …
It was Sara who found the answer.

Say it: stress the key words
It was MY grandfather who told you.

QUESTIONS **What do you like most about learning English?**

What I like most is the stories.

5 Idioms, proverbs and phrases

IDIOM

have butterflies in your stomach

to feel very nervous before you do something

Example: *I always have butterflies in my stomach before an exam.*

PROVERB

Where there's a will, there's a way.

If you really want to do something, you will find a way to do it.

Example: *He had no money for university, so he worked and saved. Where there's a will, there's a way.*

PHRASE

pull yourself together

to control your feelings and become calm again

Example: *She was crying, but she pulled herself together and finished her speech.*

6 New words

calm	quiet and not nervous	**confidence**	the feeling that you can do something well
tower	the tall building at an airport where people tell pilots what to do	**cleared**	allowed to do something
airfield	a small airport	**regret**	feel sorry about something you did

CONVERSATION · LESSON 13

Tell Me About a Time When…

Answering harder interview questions with examples from your life

- Answer questions with real examples
- Give emphasis to your strengths
- Talk about a mistake and what you learned

1 Read the conversation

Adam has an interview for a cadet program at an airline. Ms. Salma, a senior captain, is interviewing him.

MS. SALMA	Good morning, Adam. Thank you for coming. Let's start. Why do you want to fly for an airline?
ADAM	What I love most about flying is the responsibility. In a plane, every decision matters, and I want a job where people can trust me.
MS. SALMA	Tell me about a time when you had to **think on your feet**.
ADAM	Last month, during a training flight, my radio stopped working. It was then that I remembered the light signals from the tower. I followed them, and I landed safely.
MS. SALMA	That's impressive. How do you **work under pressure**?
ADAM	I stay calm and follow my checklist. What helps me most is planning. If I've prepared well, I don't panic.
MS. SALMA	Tell me about a time when you made a mistake.
ADAM	In my third lesson, I forgot one check before take-off, and my instructor noticed. It was that day that I started writing every check on a card. I've never forgotten one since.
MS. SALMA	Good. One last question. Why should we choose you?
ADAM	Because I'm careful, I'm calm, and I never stop learning. And it's the pilots who never stop learning who become the best captains.

Tell Me About a Time When… (continued)

2 Useful phrases

SAY WHY YOU WANT THE JOB
What I love most about flying is the responsibility.

ANSWER: TELL ME ABOUT A TIME WHEN…
Last month, during a training flight, my radio stopped working.

SAY WHAT YOU DID
It was then that I remembered the light signals.

TALK ABOUT PRESSURE
I stay calm and follow my checklist.

LEARN FROM A MISTAKE
It was that day that I started writing every check on a card.

SELL YOURSELF
I'm careful, I'm calm, and I never stop learning.

3 Idioms, proverbs and phrases

IDIOM

think on your feet

to make good decisions quickly, without time to plan

Example: *When the lights went out during her talk, she had to think on her feet.*

PHRASE

work under pressure

to do your work well when you have very little time or a lot of stress

Example: *Nurses often have to work under pressure.*

4 New words

cadet	a young person who is training for a job such as pilot	**responsibility**	a duty to take care of something or someone
signals	lights or sounds that give a message	**impressive**	very good, in a way that you admire
checklist	a list of things you must check or do	**panic**	suddenly feel so afraid that you can't think clearly